MargDarshak-AI

Product Requirements Document

What we are building, for whom, and how we will judge it

Status	Draft v1.0
Date	7 November 2026
Product	MargDarshak-AI, web app
Audience	Students in India (school and college)

1. Why this exists

Most students in India pick a stream, a degree or a first career direction with very little real information. The advice they get tends to come from relatives, friends or whatever is trending, and personal counselling is either hard to reach or expensive. Generic online quizzes usually end with a job title and nothing else.

MargDarshak-AI fills that gap. A student describes their interests, strengths and situation once, and gets back a set of career options that explain themselves, plus a concrete plan for the next six months. The aim is to give the student somewhere solid to start exploring, not to hand down a verdict.

2. Goals and non-goals

Goals

- A student can finish an assessment and see useful results in one sitting.
- Every suggestion comes with reasons, skills involved, gaps and first steps, so it can be acted on.
- Students can come back later: saved assessments and tracked progress.
- The results screen is built from what the AI returned, not from a fixed list of careers.

Non-goals

- No promise of admission, a job, a salary or success in any career. This is stated in the product.
- Not a replacement for a human counsellor, teacher or parent.
- No college search, entrance exam coaching, or job listings in this version.
- No counsellor marketplace or payments.

3. Who it is for

User	Situation	What they need
School student (class 9 to 12)	Choosing a stream or preparing for entrance exams	Plain-language options, what each career actually involves, what to study next
Undergraduate	Unsure the current course fits, or looking for skills beyond the syllabus	Skill gaps, a learning plan, small projects to build
Career switcher or fresher	Has some background, wants a new direction	Realistic paths from where they are now

4. What the product does

Requirements are grouped by priority. **Must** means the first release does not ship without it.

ID	Requirement	Priority
R1	Assessment form capturing interests, strengths and preferences, with optional Indian education and career context (board, stream, current course, location preference, etc.)	Must
R2	Free-text field for personal instructions (for example, "I do not want a desk job")	Must
R3	Generate 5 career options by default; the student can choose any number from 5 to 10	Must
R4	For each career: why it may fit, skills it uses, likely skill gaps, practical first steps	Must
R5	Six-month learning roadmap and beginner-friendly project ideas	Must
R6	Dashboard renders the returned analysis dynamically; nothing about specific careers is hardcoded	Must
R7	Sign up and sign in with email and password	Must
R8	Google sign-in, available only when configured on the server	Should
R9	Save assessments and view them later	Must
R10	Mark roadmap items as done and see progress	Must
R11	Submit feedback on a result	Should
R12	Sign out and switch accounts; each user sees only their own data	Must
R13	Visible disclaimer: suggestions are starting points, not guarantees	Must
R14	Works well on a phone screen	Must
R15	Re-run an assessment with edited answers and compare with the earlier one	Could

5. The main journey

1. Student lands on the home page and starts an assessment (sign-in is requested before results are saved).
2. They answer the questions and, if they want, add context and personal instructions.
3. They pick how many careers they want to see (5 to 10).
4. The app shows a loading state while the analysis is generated, then opens the dashboard.
5. They read the careers, open the roadmap, and tick off the first steps over the following weeks.
6. Later they sign in again, find the saved assessment, and carry on from where they stopped.

6. How we will know it works

There is no usage history yet, so numeric targets will be set after the first batch of real users. What we will measure from day one:

Measure	What it tells us
Assessment completion rate	Whether the form is too long or confusing
Share of results that are saved	Whether the output felt worth keeping
Return visits within 30 days	Whether students use it as a plan, not a one-off quiz

Measure	What it tells us
Roadmap items marked done	Whether the steps are realistic enough to attempt
Feedback ratings and comments	Quality of the AI output, and where it goes wrong

7. Risks

Risk	Why it matters	What we do about it
AI gives wrong or generic advice	Students may act on it	Structured prompts with the student's own context, clear disclaimer, feedback button to catch bad output
Output in the wrong shape	Dashboard would break	Validate the response against a schema and retry once before showing an error
Sensitive data about young users	Many users may be minors	Collect only what is needed, scope data per user, no data selling, delete on request
Model cost and rate limits	Heavy use could stall the app	Per-user rate limit, request timeout, cached saved results
Bias toward popular careers	Narrow or stereotyped suggestions	Prompt asks for varied options including non-obvious ones; review feedback regularly

8. Later, not now

- Hindi and other regional languages.
- Exporting a result as a PDF to share with parents or teachers.
- Optional hand-off to a human counsellor.
- Pointers to relevant courses and free learning resources inside the roadmap.

9. Open questions

- What is the minimum age we allow, and do we need parental consent flows?
- How long should an assessment take: 5 minutes or 15?
- Do we keep saved results forever or let users delete them with one click?
- Which regions and languages come first after launch?